

Print Content

Japan Packing Checklist

Trip dates: _____ Cities: _____ Days: _____

1. Documents & Money

- ☒ Passport (valid 6+ months)
- ☒ Visa or entry permit (if required for your nationality)
- ☒ Printed flight / e-ticket confirmation
- ☒ Hotel / accommodation bookings
- ☒ Travel insurance card and policy number
- ☒ Driver's license + International Driving Permit (if renting a car)
- ☒ Credit / debit cards (tell your bank you're traveling)
- ☒ Some Japanese yen in cash (many small shops are cash-only)
- ☒ Coin purse (Japan uses a lot of coins)
- ☒ Emergency contact list on paper
- ☒ Photocopies / phone photos of passport and cards

2. Electronics

- ☒ Phone + charging cable
- ☒ Power bank (carry-on only, not checked luggage)
- ☒ Plug adapter (Japan uses Type A two flat pins, 100V)
- ☒ Camera + memory card + charger
- ☒ Earphones / headphones
- ☒ Pocket Wi-Fi or travel SIM / eSIM
- ☒ Multi-port USB charger
- ☒ E-reader / tablet
- ☒ Watch or fitness tracker + charger

3. Health & Toiletries

- ☒ Prescription medicine + copy of prescription
- ☒ Pain relief, motion-sickness, stomach, and cold tablets
- ☒ Hand sanitizer and pocket tissues (some restrooms lack both)
- ☒ Small towel / handkerchief (handy in public restrooms)
- ☒ Toothbrush, toothpaste, floss
- ☒ Deodorant
- ☒ Sunscreen
- ☒ Any contact lenses / glasses + spare
- ☒ Adhesive bandages and basic first aid

- ☒ Face masks (commonly worn in public)

4. Clothing by Season

Spring (Mar-May): mild, layers, occasional rain

- ☒ Light jacket or cardigan
- ☒ Long-sleeve tops + a few short-sleeve
- ☒ Compact umbrella
- ☒ Comfortable walking shoes

Summer (Jun-Aug): hot, humid, rainy season early on

- ☒ Breathable short-sleeve shirts
- ☒ Shorts / light trousers
- ☒ Sun hat and sunglasses
- ☒ Compact umbrella (rain + sun)
- ☒ Quick-dry socks and a spare shirt for sweat

Autumn (Sep-Nov): mild cooling, layers

- ☒ Light to medium jacket
- ☒ Long-sleeve layers
- ☒ Scarf for cooler evenings
- ☒ Comfortable walking shoes

Winter (Dec-Feb): cold, snowy in the north and mountains

- ☒ Warm coat
- ☒ Thermal base layers
- ☒ Gloves, hat, scarf
- ☒ Warm socks
- ☒ Waterproof shoes / boots for snowy areas

5. Footwear & Bags

- ☒ One pair of broken-in walking shoes (you'll walk a lot)
- ☒ Slip-on shoes (you remove shoes indoors at many places)
- ☒ Spare socks (no holes — shoes come off indoors)
- ☒ Day bag / small backpack
- ☒ Foldable tote for shopping
- ☒ Packing cubes

6. Japan-Specific Items

- ☒ IC transit card (Suica / ICOCA / PASMO) or plan to buy on arrival
- ☒ Coin purse for vending machines and small shops
- ☒ Reusable shopping bag (plastic bags are often charged)
- ☒ Small foldable bag for trash (public bins are scarce)
- ☒ Compact umbrella

- ☒ Offline maps + translation app downloaded before the trip
- ☒ Slippers or socks for ryokan / temple visits
- ☒ Cash envelope for entrance fees and small vendors

7. Optional / Comfort

- ☒ Travel pillow and eye mask
- ☒ Refillable water bottle
- ☒ Snacks for travel days
- ☒ Laundry bag + travel detergent
- ☒ Mini sewing kit
- ☒ Notebook and pen

Last-Minute Checks (day of departure)

- ☒ Phone fully charged + power bank charged
- ☒ Passport and tickets in carry-on
- ☒ Liquids under limit in clear bag
- ☒ Home: lights off, appliances unplugged, doors locked
- ☒ Check-in done / boarding pass saved

Notes: _____